JanGyan — Learn Without Limits

Category 2: Government Services & Citizen Rights

Module 5 - Government Welfare Schemes

Module Overview

This handbook is your complete, beginner-to-advanced guide to **Government Welfare Schemes** — covering Education, Healthcare, Farmer Welfare, Women Empowerment, Senior Citizens, Student Scholarships, Employment, Financial Inclusion, and broader Social Welfare Programs. India runs some of the largest welfare schemes in the world; this module helps you understand which ones exist, who they're for, and how to actually access them.

By the end of this module, you will not need to search anywhere else to understand India's major welfare schemes and how to benefit from them.

Learning Objectives

After completing this module, you will be able to:

- Identify major central government welfare schemes across nine key life areas
- Understand eligibility basics for flagship schemes like PM-KISAN, Ayushman Bharat, and Jan Dhan Yojana
- Know how education, health, and financial inclusion schemes work together
- Recognise schemes relevant to women, senior citizens, farmers, and students
- Apply for or check eligibility for a scheme using official channels
- Avoid common mistakes and fraud related to welfare scheme applications

---

Why This Topic Matters

Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY, the world's largest publicly funded health insurance scheme, has issued over **43.5 crore Ayushman cards**, covering more than **55 crore people**. PM Jan Dhan Yojana has opened over **56 crore bank accounts**. PM-KISAN has disbursed roughly **₹18,000 crore** to nearly **9 crore farmers** in a single instalment alone.

> *Reality Check: Studies and on-ground surveys consistently show that a meaningful share of eligible citizens never claim benefits they qualify for — often simply because they were unaware the scheme existed or found the application process confusing.*

Welfare schemes only work if citizens know about them. This module exists to close that awareness gap.

Introduction

India's welfare architecture spans nearly every stage and need of a citizen's life — from a girl child's education savings to a senior citizen's pension, from a farmer's income support to an entrepreneur's first business loan. This module organises the landscape into nine practical categories, covering the flagship scheme(s) in each.

Fundamental Concepts

How Welfare Schemes Are Typically Delivered

Mechanism	Meaning
Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)	Money transferred directly into an Aadhaar-seeded bank account, reducing leakage
Cashless Service Delivery	Benefits like healthcare delivered directly at empanelled providers, without the citizen paying upfront
Subsidy	Government reduces the cost of a good/service (e.g., LPG cylinders)
Insurance/Pension Model	Government-backed protection against risk (health, accident, old age) at low or no cost

Central vs Centrally Sponsored vs State Schemes

Some schemes are entirely central (like PM-KISAN), while others are **Centrally Sponsored Schemes** implemented jointly with states (like Ayushman Bharat, which several states supplement with their own top-up schemes).

Complete Detailed Explanation

Part A — Education Schemes

Samagra Shiksha is the government's integrated scheme for school education, covering pre-school to senior secondary level, aiming to improve school effectiveness and learning outcomes. **PM POSHAN** (formerly the Mid-Day Meal Scheme) provides hot cooked meals to school children, supporting nutrition and school attendance. These build on the foundation of the **Right to Education (RTE) Act, 2009**, which guarantees free and compulsory education for children aged 6–14.

Part B — Healthcare Schemes

Ayushman Bharat – Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY), launched on 23 September 2018, provides **₹5 lakh per family per year** for secondary and tertiary hospitalisation, covering over 12 crore vulnerable families. Since October 2024, all senior citizens aged **70 and above** are universally eligible for an **additional ₹5 lakh** cover through the **Vay Vandana Card**, regardless of income. Treatment is cashless at empanelled hospitals across India.

Part C — Farmer Welfare Schemes

PM-KISAN (Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi) provides eligible farmer families **₹6,000 per year**, paid in three instalments of ₹2,000 directly into Aadhaar-seeded bank accounts via DBT. **PM Fasal Bima Yojana** provides crop insurance against yield losses from natural calamities, pests, and diseases, at a low farmer-paid premium.

Part D — Women Empowerment Schemes

Beti Bachao Beti Padhao promotes the survival, protection, and education of girl children. **Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana** is a small savings scheme for a girl child's future education/marriage expenses, currently offering a competitive government-set interest rate. **Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY)**, launched May 2016, provides deposit-free LPG connections to women from poor households — reaching over **10.58 crore connections** as of mid-2026, reducing health risks from traditional cooking fuels.

Part E — Senior Citizen Schemes

Pradhan Mantri Vaya Vandana Yojana (PMVVY) offers senior citizens a guaranteed pension in exchange for a lump sum investment. The **Atal Pension Yojana (APY)** guarantees a monthly pension between **₹1,000 and ₹5,000** after age 60, aimed particularly at workers in the unorganised sector. The **Vay Vandana Card** under Ayushman Bharat (described above) is a major recent addition specifically for citizens aged 70+.

Part F — Student Scholarships

The **National Scholarship Portal (NSP)** is a single central platform where students can apply for numerous central and state scholarships in one place, with amounts commonly ranging from about **₹1,000 to ₹20,000 per year**, depending on the scholarship category and education level.

Part G — Employment Schemes

MGNREGA (Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act) legally guarantees **100 days of wage employment per year** to rural households willing to do unskilled manual work, at state-notified wage rates. **PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY)** provides free, certified skill-training to youth. **PM Mudra Yojana (PMMY)**, marking 10 years in April 2025, has sanctioned over **52 crore loans worth more than ₹32 lakh crore**, offering collateral-free loans (up to ₹10 lakh, or ₹20 lakh under the newer "Tarun Plus" category) to small entrepreneurs.

Part H — Financial Inclusion Schemes

PM Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY), launched 28 August 2014, is a national financial inclusion mission that has opened over **56 crore bank accounts**, with over **38 crore free RuPay debit cards** issued (each carrying accidental insurance cover) and a combined deposit balance exceeding **₹2.68 lakh crore**. Complementary schemes like **PM Suraksha Bima Yojana** (accident insurance) and **PM Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana** (life insurance) offer low-cost annual protection linked to these bank accounts.

Part I — Social Welfare Programs

Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY), covering both Urban (PMAY-U) and Gramin/rural (PMAY-G) components, provides financial assistance for pucca (permanent) housing to eligible low-income families; PMAY-G was expanded in 2025 to target two crore additional rural houses through FY29. The broader **National Social Assistance Programme (NSAP)** provides pensions and support to elderly, widowed, and disabled citizens below the poverty line.

Important Terminologies

Term	Simple Meaning
DBT	Direct Benefit Transfer — money sent straight into a beneficiary's bank account
PMJAY	Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana, India's flagship health insurance scheme
PMJDY	Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana, the national financial inclusion mission
PMAY	Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana, the national housing scheme
NSP	National Scholarship Portal
MGNREGA	Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act
Empanelled Hospital	A hospital officially registered to provide cashless treatment under PM-JAY

Step-by-Step Understanding

How to Check Eligibility and Apply for a Central Scheme

1. Identify the scheme relevant to your need (health, farming, education, housing, etc.)
2. Visit the scheme's official portal (e.g., pmjay.gov.in, pmkisan.gov.in, pmaymis.gov.in)
3. Check eligibility criteria, which often relies on databases like SECC 2011 or state-specific criteria
4. Complete Aadhaar-based e-KYC if required
5. Submit the application with supporting documents, or visit a Common Service Centre for assistance
6. Track application/benefit status through the official portal or UMANG app

Real-Life Indian Examples

(Widely reported public initiatives, described for educational awareness.)

- **Ayushman Bharat Diwas Camps:** States have organised on-ground camps to issue Ayushman cards directly to eligible families, with Uttar Pradesh alone issuing over 5.38 crore cards toward its 9 crore target population.
- **PM-KISAN Direct Transfers:** Each instalment of PM-KISAN, such as the 21st instalment released in November 2025, moves thousands of crores directly into farmers' bank accounts within days, showcasing DBT's speed and reach.
- **PMUY Expansion:** Since its 2016 launch, PMUY has grown from zero to over 10.58 crore LPG connections, materially improving indoor air quality and health outcomes for women in low-income households.

Practical Scenarios

Scenario 1: A family in a rural area needs expensive hospital treatment they can't afford upfront.
Check eligibility for Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY and visit an empanelled hospital for cashless treatment up to ₹5 lakh/year.

Scenario 2: A small farmer wants regular income support for household and farming expenses.
Register for PM-KISAN via the official portal or Common Service Centre to receive ₹6,000/year in three instalments.

Scenario 3: A young graduate wants to start a small business but lacks collateral for a loan.
Explore PM Mudra Yojana for a collateral-free loan up to ₹10 lakh (or ₹20 lakh under Tarun Plus).

Scenario 4: A student from a low-income family needs financial help to continue their education.
Apply through the National Scholarship Portal (NSP), which aggregates numerous central and state scholarships in one place.

Government Rules / Guidelines

- **Ministry of Health & Family Welfare / National Health Authority:** Implements Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY.
- **Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare:** Implements PM-KISAN and PM Fasal Bima Yojana.
- **Ministry of Finance (Department of Financial Services):** Oversees PM Jan Dhan Yojana, Atal Pension Yojana, and related insurance schemes.
- **Ministry of Rural Development / Housing and Urban Affairs:** Implement PMAY-G and PMAY-U respectively.
- **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas:** Implements PM Ujjwala Yojana.

Laws & Policies

Scheme / Policy	Legal/Policy Basis
Right to Education Act, 2009	Legal foundation for free and compulsory education, ages 6–14
Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY	Based on National Health Policy, 2017, recommendations
MGNREGA	Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005
National Social Assistance Programme (NSAP)	A centrally sponsored scheme under the Ministry of Rural Development

---

Important Statistics

Metric	Figure
Ayushman cards issued	Over 43.5 crore
People covered under PM-JAY	Over 55 crore
PM-JAY cover per family/year	₹5 lakh (plus additional ₹5 lakh for citizens aged 70+)
PM-KISAN 21st instalment (Nov 2025)	~₹18,000 crore to ~9 crore farmers
PM Jan Dhan accounts opened	Over 56 crore
Jan Dhan deposit balance	Over ₹2.68 lakh crore
PMUY LPG connections (mid-2026)	Over 10.58 crore
PM Mudra Yojana loans sanctioned (since 2015)	Over 52 crore, worth over ₹32 lakh crore
Atal Pension Yojana monthly pension range	₹1,000 to ₹5,000

(Figures are approximate, drawn from PIB, ministry, and scheme-specific publications through 2025–2026.)

Best Practices

- Check eligibility directly on official scheme portals, not third-party websites
- Keep Aadhaar linked and updated across bank accounts for smooth DBT
- Use Common Service Centres (CSCs) for assistance if you're unfamiliar with online applications
- Apply for education/health schemes as early as eligibility allows, rather than waiting
- Track application status regularly rather than assuming it will proceed automatically

Common Mistakes

- Not checking eligibility because of assuming a scheme "won't apply to me"
- Missing Aadhaar-seeding or e-KYC steps, delaying DBT payments
- Falling for fraudulent agents who charge unofficial "fees" for free government schemes
- Not renewing or updating documents (income certificates, bank details) when required
- Ignoring official scheme deadlines or renewal cycles

Myths vs Facts

Myth	Fact
"Government schemes always require paying an agent"	Most flagship schemes are free to apply for directly through official portals or CSCs
"Ayushman Bharat only covers a small list of diseases"	It covers a very wide range of secondary and tertiary treatments, though certain very high-end procedures remain excluded
"PM-KISAN is only for large landowners"	It is specifically designed to support small and marginal farmer families
"Scholarships are only for students with the highest marks"	Many scholarships target need-based and category-based eligibility, not just merit
"MGNREGA guarantees a permanent job"	It guarantees up to 100 days of wage employment per year, not permanent employment

Do's and Don'ts

Do	Don't
Apply through official scheme portals or CSCs	Don't pay unofficial "agents" for free government schemes
Keep Aadhaar and bank details updated	Don't ignore e-KYC or seeding requirements
Check eligibility even if unsure	Don't assume a scheme doesn't apply to you without checking
Track application status regularly	Don't submit and forget — follow up if delayed
Use UMANG or official apps to monitor multiple schemes	Don't rely on unofficial social media posts for scheme details

Safety Tips

For Applying Safely

- Always use official `.gov.in` portals or the UMANG app for applications
- Never pay money to anyone claiming to guarantee scheme approval for a fee

For Health & Insurance Schemes

- Verify hospital empanelment status directly via the scheme's official hospital locator
- Keep your Ayushman card and ID proof accessible when seeking treatment

For Financial Schemes

- Verify your bank account is properly Aadhaar-seeded for DBT schemes
- Be cautious of unsolicited calls/messages claiming to "activate" your scheme benefits for a fee

Practical Checklist

- [ ] Checked eligibility for Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY
- [ ] Verified PM-KISAN registration status, if a farmer
- [ ] Confirmed Jan Dhan/bank account is Aadhaar-seeded for DBT
- [ ] Explored National Scholarship Portal for eligible students in the family
- [ ] Checked Ujjwala Yojana eligibility for LPG connection, if applicable
- [ ] Reviewed Atal Pension Yojana or PMVVY for senior family members
- [ ] Verified housing scheme (PMAY) eligibility, if applicable

---

Quick Revision Notes

- Nine key welfare areas: Education, Healthcare, Farmer Welfare, Women Empowerment, Senior Citizens, Scholarships, Employment, Financial Inclusion, Social Welfare
- Flagship schemes: PM-JAY (health), PM-KISAN (farmers), Jan Dhan Yojana (financial inclusion), Ujjwala Yojana (women/LPG), Mudra Yojana (employment/business), PMAY (housing)
- Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) is the backbone delivery mechanism for most schemes
- Applications are free through official portals — never pay unofficial agents
- Aadhaar-seeded bank accounts are essential for most scheme benefits

---

Key Takeaways

1. India runs some of the world's largest welfare schemes — awareness is the biggest barrier to access, not eligibility
2. Most schemes are entirely free to apply for through official channels
3. Aadhaar and DBT are the common infrastructure connecting nearly every scheme
4. Different life needs (health, farming, education, old age) each have dedicated flagship schemes
5. Checking your own and your family's eligibility across all nine categories can reveal benefits you didn't know you qualified for

---

Glossary

- **DBT** — Direct Benefit Transfer
- **Empanelled Hospital** — A hospital registered to provide cashless treatment under a health scheme
- **MGNREGA** — Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act

- **NSP** — National Scholarship Portal
- **PMAY** — Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana
- **PMJAY** — Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana
- **PMJDY** — Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana
- **PMMY** — Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana
- **PMUY** — Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana

Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY?
India's flagship health insurance scheme providing ₹5 lakh per family per year for hospitalisation, covering over 12 crore vulnerable families.

2. Who is eligible for PM-KISAN?
Small and marginal farmer families meeting the scheme's eligibility criteria, receiving ₹6,000/year via DBT.

3. What is PM Jan Dhan Yojana?
India's national financial inclusion mission, providing basic bank accounts, RuPay cards, and linked insurance to citizens.

4. Do I need to pay for a Jan Dhan account?
No — these are zero-balance accounts free to open through any participating bank.

5. What is PMUY?
Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana, providing deposit-free LPG connections to women from poor households.

6. What is the National Scholarship Portal?
A single platform where students can apply for numerous central and state scholarships.

7. How much wage employment does MGNREGA guarantee?
Up to 100 days per year for willing rural households, at state-notified wage rates.

8. What is PM Mudra Yojana?
A scheme offering collateral-free loans up to ₹10 lakh (or ₹20 lakh under "Tarun Plus") to small entrepreneurs.

9. What is the Atal Pension Yojana?
A pension scheme guaranteeing ₹1,000–₹5,000 monthly pension after age 60, aimed at unorganised sector workers.

10. Are senior citizens covered differently under Ayushman Bharat?
Yes — since October 2024, all citizens aged 70+ get an additional ₹5 lakh cover via the Vay Vandana Card, regardless of income.

11. What is PMAY?
Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana, providing financial assistance for pucca housing to eligible low-income families, in both urban and rural forms.

12. Is PM-JAY treatment really cashless?
Yes, at empanelled hospitals, eligible beneficiaries do not pay for covered treatment.

13. Can I apply for these schemes without going online?
Yes — Common Service Centres (CSCs) can help citizens apply for most schemes offline/assisted.

14. What is Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)?
A system transferring scheme benefits directly into a beneficiary's Aadhaar-seeded bank account.

15. What happens if my bank account isn't Aadhaar-seeded?
DBT-based scheme payments (like PM-KISAN) may be delayed or fail until seeding is completed.

16. Is Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana only for girls?
Yes — it is specifically a savings scheme for a girl child's future education/marriage needs.

17. What is PM Fasal Bima Yojana?
A crop insurance scheme protecting farmers against yield losses from natural calamities, pests, and diseases.

18. Are all these schemes free to apply for?
Yes — legitimate applications through official portals or CSCs do not require any payment to "guarantee" approval.

19. What should I do if someone asks for money to process my scheme application?
Refuse and report it — official scheme applications never require unofficial payments.

20. Can I check multiple scheme statuses in one place?
Yes — many can be tracked via the UMANG app alongside their individual official portals.

21. Are welfare schemes only for very poor families?
No — eligibility varies widely; some, like Jan Dhan Yojana or Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana, are open to a much broader population.

22. Where can I find the complete, updated list of all central schemes?
On the India.gov.in National Portal and the MyGov and UMANG platforms.

Suggested Infographics, Flowcharts & Illustrations

(For JanGyan design team — placement suggestions only; no images generated here)

- **"Nine Welfare Categories" icon wheel** → within "Introduction"
- **Flagship scheme comparison table graphic** → within "Complete Detailed Explanation"
- **DBT flow diagram (Scheme → Aadhaar-seeded account → Beneficiary)** → within "Fundamental Concepts"
- **Eligibility checklist visual card per scheme category** → near "Practical Checklist"
- **PM-JAY cashless treatment process flowchart** → within "Complete Detailed Explanation, Part B"

Official References

- National Health Authority — Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY statistics and guidelines
- Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare — PM-KISAN and PM Fasal Bima Yojana documentation
- Department of Financial Services — PM Jan Dhan Yojana, Atal Pension Yojana statistics
- Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas — PMUY statistics and press releases
- Ministry of Rural Development / Housing and Urban Affairs — PMAY-G and PMAY-U documentation
- Press Information Bureau (PIB), Government of India — scheme milestone releases

---

Official Government Website Links

- Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY: **https://pmjay.gov.in**
- PM-KISAN: **https://pmkisan.gov.in**
- PM Jan Dhan Yojana: **https://pmjdy.gov.in**
- National Scholarship Portal: **https://scholarships.gov.in**
- PMAY: **https://pmaymis.gov.in**
- UMANG: **https://web.umang.gov.in**
- India.gov.in (National Portal): **https://www.india.gov.in**

Conclusion

India's welfare schemes touch nearly every stage of life — health, education, farming income, housing, and old age. But these schemes only help the citizens who know they exist and how to access them. This handbook is meant to be your quick-reference map across nine major areas of government support, so that you and your family never miss out on a benefit you're entitled to simply due to a lack of awareness.

This is the next step in your Government Services & Citizen Rights journey with JanGyan. Stay informed, stay proactive, and remember: **the scheme that helps you most is the one you actually know about.**

JanGyan — Learn Without Limits
Module 5 of the Government Services & Citizen Rights Category